

after its initial launch price of above 40,000 bucks, (which hardly anybody thought it was worth), it's down to below Rs. 30,000 – I saw it selling for Rs. 28,500 – a decent deal, but I still feel it's a waste on account of the interface.

One phone that really pleased me was the Samsung Omnia HD. Not only does it have a capacitive touch screen and a very good on-screen keypad, the device runs Symbian – that is pretty snappy and works well with a finger-based touch interface. The Omnia HD has other tricks up its sleeve, like an 8-megapixel camera and 720p video recorder. It also has a nice screen and is a good option for those who want a cheaper alternative to the iPhone. Priced at Rs. 27,500 or thereabouts, I feel the Omnia HD is a really good option for someone looking for a multimedia-rich smartphone. I also came across LGs KM900 Arena, a phone that we tested earlier – priced now at around Rs. 23,000, this phone has an amazing screen and very nice navigation owing to the 3-inch capacitive touch display. I prefer the Samsung Omnia HD. For someone looking at decent smartphone mainly for music, I recommend Sony Ericsson's W205 – priced at the Rs. 4,900 mark, this is a neat phone, the screen isn't too great but I couldn't find much else to complain.

I've found QWERTY keypads to be a double-edged sword. You get a full keypad that allows quick typing out of longer mails, yet I find a number keypad faster and more convenient for text messaging – probably because a QWERTY needs a little more concentration and probably two thumbs which means two hands. However, If you think that every QWERTY phone is amazing for mails and working with documents – think again. This depends on the design of the keypad. I absolutely loved the keypad on the Blackberry Bold and the Blackberry Curve 8900 – although different from each other, the bevelling of the keys, the gaps between each key both vertically and horizontally and the keypad layout was really intuitive – such that it allowed quick use. For a QWERTY phone, you need to use the keypad before buying it, especially if you're buying one for functional use of the keypad rather than



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